SUNDAY SCHOOL MANUAL

RESISTING WORLDLINESS

Memory Verse: 1 John 2:15

Text: 1 John 2:15-17 | John 17:14-16

Sunday, 8th March 2026

DEFINITIONS

➤ Meaning of 'Resist'

To resist is the act of standing firm against something that is trying to influence, control, or pressure you.

➤ Worldliness Defined

Worldliness is adopting the values, desires, lifestyle and system of this sinful world that are contrary to God's will — it includes not being controlled by the love of the things of this world.

INTRODUCTION

According to John 17:14–16, Jesus prayed for His disciples that God should keep them in the world by His word, because He knew that there is a lot of evil in the world that can separate believers from God or make Christians enemies of God, by removing their hearts from God.

THREE (3) FORMS / ROOTS OF WORLDLINESS — 1 John 2:15–16

(1) Lust of the Flesh — Sinful physical desire.

(2) Lust of the Eyes — Envy, greed, and covetousness.

(3) Pride of Life — Arrogance and show-off.

EVIDENCE OF WORLDLINESS IN A CHRISTIAN

(1) Conformity in Dressing — Conforming to worldly dress standards that do not reflect godliness. *(Prov. 7:10)*

(2) Obsession with Material Things — Being consumed or obsessed with acquiring material possessions. *(Luke 12:15)*

(3) Worldly Entertainment — Engaging in entertainment that is contrary to God's standards. *(Eph. 5:3–4; 1 Cor. 10:31; Col. 3:16–17)*

(4) Custom — A tradition and widely accepted way of behaving or doing something that is specific to a particular society, place or time. *(1 Cor. 11:6)*

EXAMPLES OF THOSE THAT EMBRACED WORLDLINESS

(a) Solomon — He allowed worldliness to draw his heart away from God. *(Neh. 13:26)*

(b) Demas — He forsook Paul, having loved the present world. *(2 Tim. 4:10)*

DANGERS OF WORLDLINESS

(1) It separates us from God. *(James 4:4)*

(2) The world and everything in it will pass away. *(1 John 2:17)*

HOW TO RESIST WORLDLINESS

(1) Renew Your Mind — Fill your mind (brain and thought) with God's word. *(Rom. 12:2)*

(2) Guard Your Heart — Be careful of what you watch, listen to and read. *(Prov. 4:23)*

(3) Choose and Be Surrounded by Godly Friends — Surround yourself with friends who will draw you closer to God. *(1 Cor. 15:33)*

(4) Walk in the Spirit — Depend on the Holy Spirit to overcome the desires of the flesh. *(Gal. 5:16)*

(5) Set Your Affection Above — Fix your mind on things above and not on earthly things. *(Col. 3:2)*

(6) Be Rooted in the Word of God — Let the word of God dwell richly in you as your standard. *(Psalm 119:11; Heb. 12:4)*

CONCLUSION

John 17:16 — We are in the world, but we are not of the world.

Memory Verse: *"Do not love the world or anything in the world. If anyone loves the world, love for the Father is not in them."*
— 1 John 2:15